

“Android was the obvious choice for Lenovo smartphones”

It hasn't been long since Lenovo ventured into the smartphone segment, yet the company aims to be amongst the top three players in India in this segment very soon. Like many others, Lenovo has also banked on Android for its debut in the smartphone market and plans to do so for its future devices as well. **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You** spoke to **Sudhin Mathur, director, Smartphones, Lenovo India**, about the company's strategy for the Indian market. Excerpts:



Sudhin Mathur, director, Smartphones, Lenovo

Q: How has Lenovo's journey been in the smartphone business so far?

We began our journey in the Indian smartphone domain this year, and have recently launched six new products in the market. The K900, which is our flagship product; the S series, which is for the more fashion conscious and stylish consumers; the P series, which is targeted to our professional consumers; and the A series, which is for consumers looking at entry level devices. For the past four months or so that we have spent in the Indian smartphone market, we have

received some exceptionally good feedback. We will now expand our portfolio. This is one segment where the shelf life of a device is reducing with every passing day.

Q: Can you throw some light on what kind of products we can expect from Lenovo in the upcoming festive season?

In the next two months, you would see about eight to nine smartphones from Lenovo across all the segments. We will experiment with everything, including the colour of the device, upgrades, and higher memories, et al.

Q: Why is Lenovo only present in the smartphone category? Why is the feature phone segment being ignored by you?

From the product range point of view, we have products starting from Rs 7000 to Rs 7500, going up to Rs 29,000. As I said, as we approach the festival season, there are some gaps in price bands that will get plugged as well. We will move down into the lower price category and we will strengthen our smartphone portfolio. The reason why we are not in the feature phone area is simple. It's the smartphone category that is growing rapidly. In fact, not just in India, if you look at the global trend, smartphones continue to grab the lion's share in the market. Smartphones are the way forward, largely because consumers are now upgrading and they are looking at a higher value from their products, including the better processing power and bigger screens. The future lies more in the smartphone segment. If you look at the IDC data, by 2017, India will have over 160 million smartphones and we will be the third largest smartphone market in the world. I think this is the right time for us or any other smartphone maker to venture into this market. That is why Lenovo is focusing only on smartphones.